



Artillery exchange

The battle for Yorktown in April–May 1862 was largely an artillery duel. McClellan was confident his guns were superior to those of the enemy and was hesitant to attack Confederate fortifications without prior reconnaissance.

Cautious approach

McClellan advanced up the Peninsula at a snail's pace along muddy roads. His army took two weeks to march 50 miles (80km) from Williamsburg, before setting up camp near Richmond between the Pamunkey and Chickahominy rivers. McClellan called for reinforcements. Lincoln refused to send any by sea, but he did order a 40,000-strong corps under Irvin McDowell to advance overland from Fredericksburg to join the Army of the Potomac. Much to McClellan's anger, this move was canceled in response to Jackson's victory at Winchester in the Shenandoah Valley on May 25. The Confederates, meanwhile, viewed their situation with alarm, and